GOOGLE CLOUD SKILLS | HANDS-ON LAB REPORT

APIs Explorer: Cloud Storage

Google Cloud self-paced lab · Lab ID: GSP421

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DATE COMPLETED	15 October 2026
PLATFORM	Google Cloud (Cloud Storage JSON API)
LEVEL / DURATION	Introductory / 15 minutes
FINAL SCORE	100 / 100

1. Overview

The Google APIs Explorer lets you browse APIs and their methods, read inline documentation, and execute authenticated requests with live responses, all from the browser. Cloud Storage offers worldwide storage and retrieval of any amount of data.

In this lab I used the APIs Explorer to call the Cloud Storage JSON API directly: creating buckets, copying an object between buckets, and deleting objects and a bucket, without using the Cloud console UI to perform the actions.

2. Objectives

- Create Cloud Storage buckets using the APIs Explorer
- Upload image files to a Cloud Storage bucket
- Copy an image file to another bucket using the APIs Explorer
- Delete image files from a bucket using the APIs Explorer
- Delete a Cloud Storage bucket using the APIs Explorer

3. Resources and Methods Used

Resource	Details
Bucket 1	qwiklabs-gcp-01-2250d8d21528 – US multi-region, Standard class
Bucket 2	yabesh-gcp-storage-lab-4821 – US multi-region, Standard class
Objects (bucket 1)	demo-image1.png (402 KB), demo-image2.png (2.1 MB)
Copied object (bucket 2)	demo-image1-copy.png (401,951 bytes, image/png)
API	Google Cloud Storage JSON API (enabled in APIs & Services)

API methods

Method	HTTP request	Purpose
Buckets: insert	POST /storage/v1/b	Create a bucket
Objects: copy	POST /storage/v1/b/{sourceBucket}/o/{sourceObject}/copyTo/b/{destBucket}/o/{destObject}	Copy an object between buckets
Objects: delete	DELETE /storage/v1/b/{bucket}/o/{object}	Delete an object
Buckets: delete	DELETE /storage/v1/b/{bucket}	Delete an empty bucket

The buckets and objects were temporary and were removed when the lab ended.

4. Step-by-Step Walkthrough

Task 1 – Create a Cloud Storage bucket

From *APIs & Services* > *Library* I opened the **Google Cloud Storage JSON API** and confirmed it was enabled.

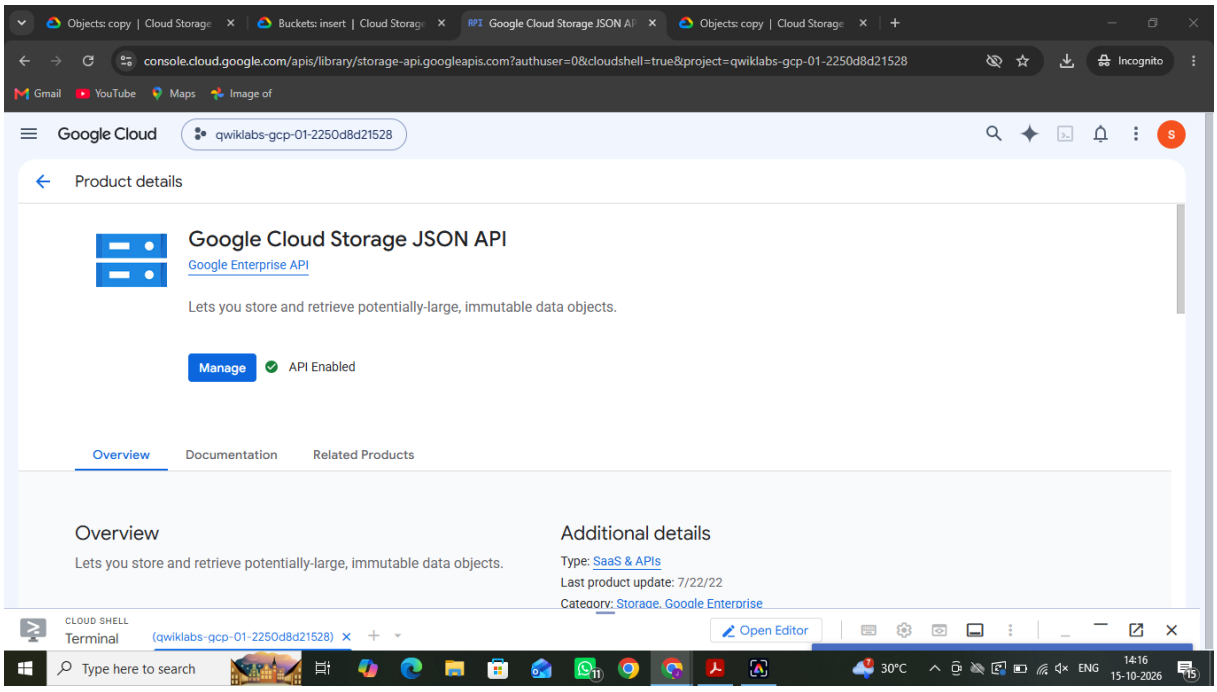


Figure 1: Google Cloud Storage JSON API with the status "API Enabled".

I then opened the **Buckets: insert** reference, which loads the APIs Explorer in a side panel. In the request parameters I set **project** to the lab's project ID (no trailing spaces) and, in the request body, gave the bucket a unique **name**. I made sure the *Google OAuth 2.0* and *API key* credentials were selected, clicked **Execute**, and authorised the APIs Explorer with the student account.

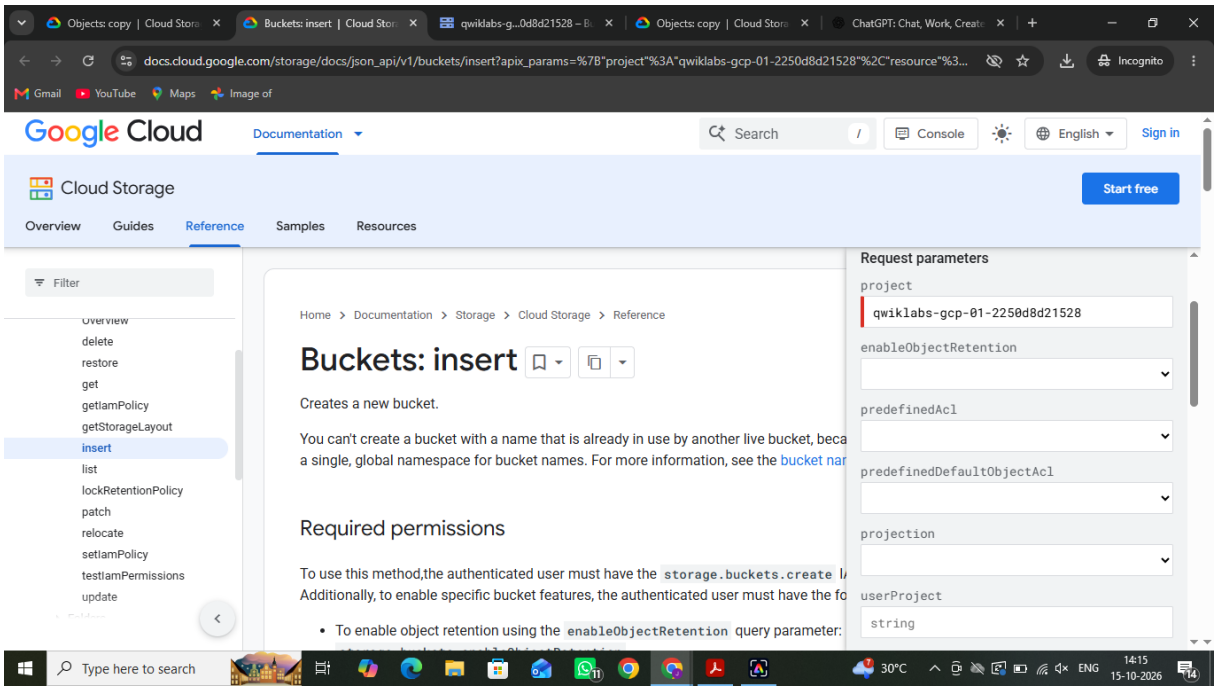


Figure 2: Buckets: insert – the project field is set to the lab's project ID.

Task 2 – Create a second bucket

With the same method I created a second bucket named **yabesh-gcp-storage-lab-4821**. The API returned **200** with a *storage#bucket* resource: location US, storage class STANDARD, and a soft-delete retention of 604,800 seconds (7 days).

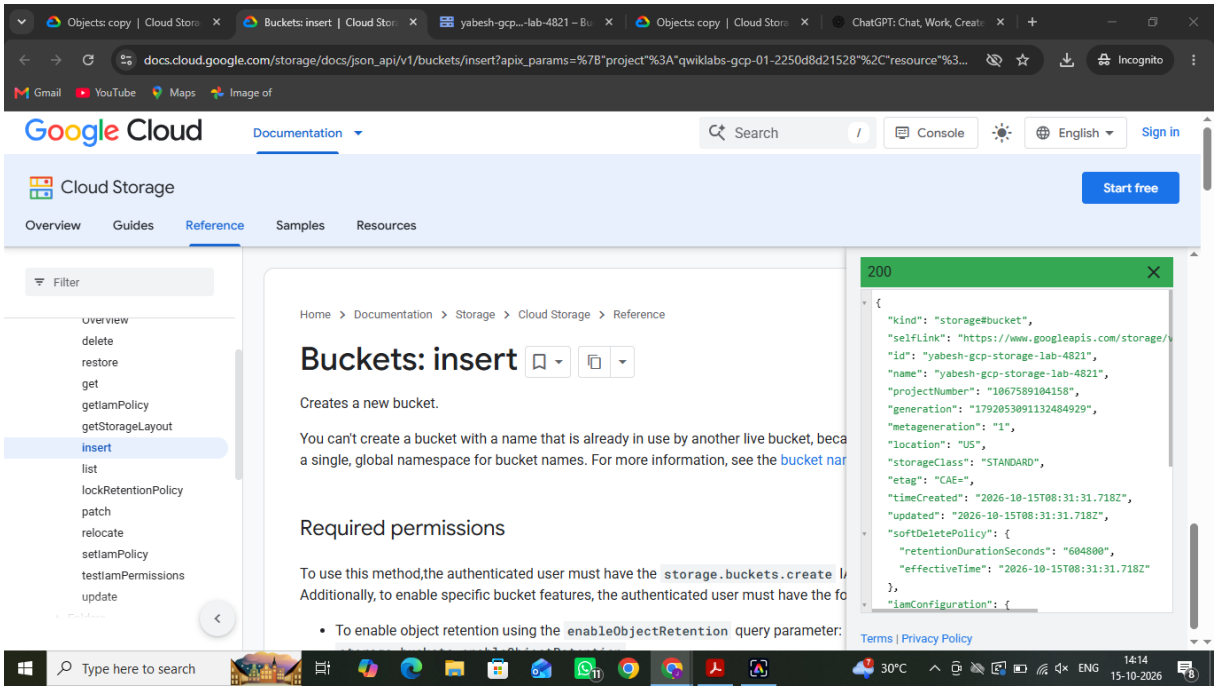


Figure 3: 200 response from Buckets: insert for the second bucket.

In the Cloud console, *Cloud Storage* > *Buckets* lists both buckets, each a Standard-class multi-region (US) bucket.

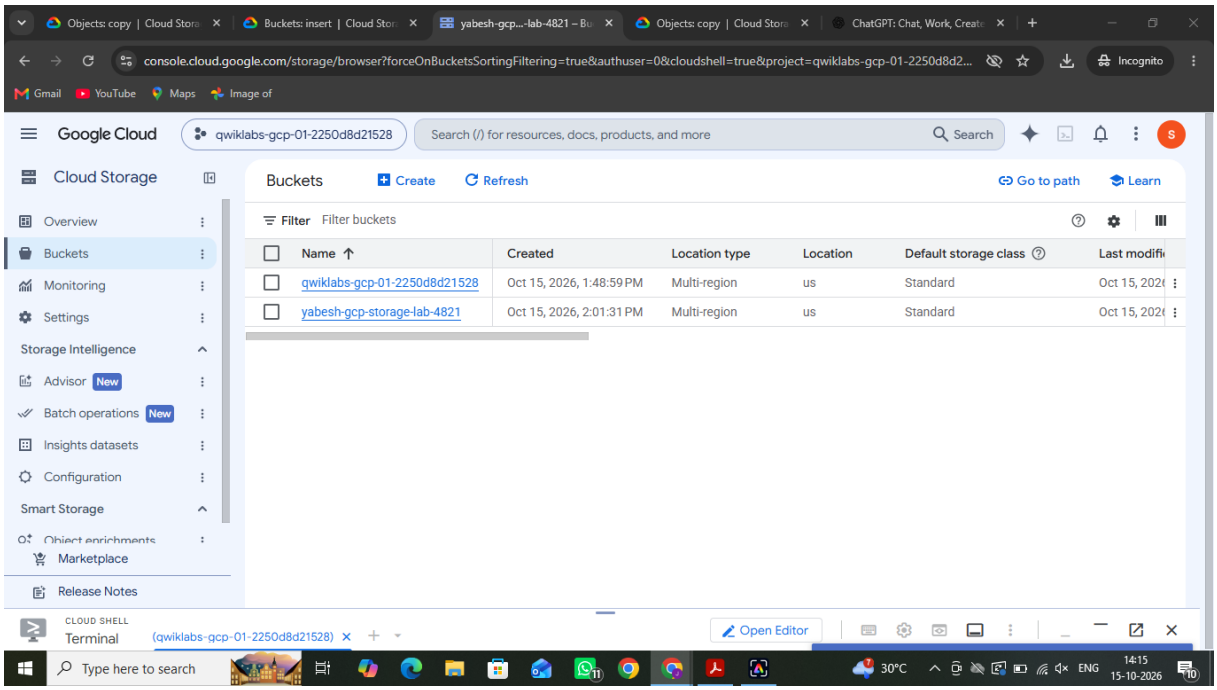


Figure 4: Buckets page showing qwiklabs-gcp-01-2250d8d21528 and yabesh-gcp-storage-lab-4821.

Task 3 – Upload files

I downloaded the two lab images as **demo-image1.png** and **demo-image2.png** and uploaded them to the first bucket with *Upload > Upload files*.

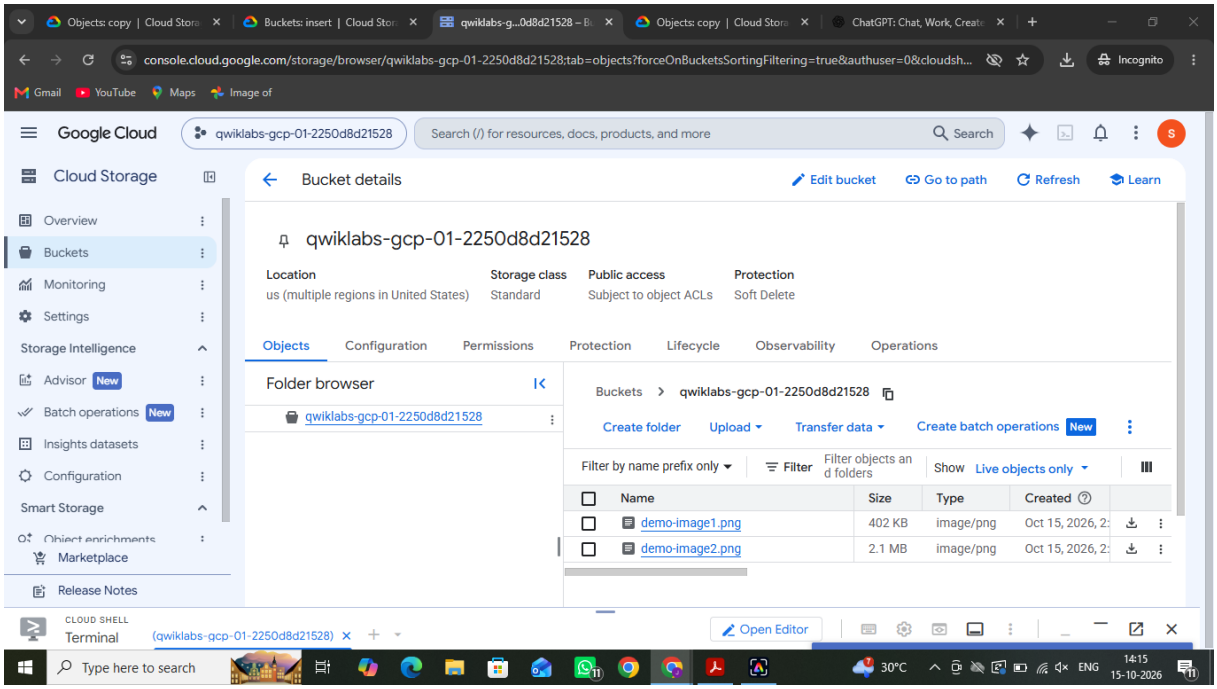


Figure 5: First bucket (qwiklabs-gcp-01-2250d8d21528) containing demo-image1.png (402 KB) and demo-image2.png (2.1 MB).

Task 4 – Copy a file between buckets

Using the **Objects: copy** method I copied the first image into the second bucket under a new name. The request parameters were:

Parameter	Value
sourceBucket	qwiklabs-gcp-01-2250d8d21528
sourceObject	demo-image1.png
destinationBucket	yabesh-gcp-storage-lab-4821
destinationObject	demo-image1-copy.png

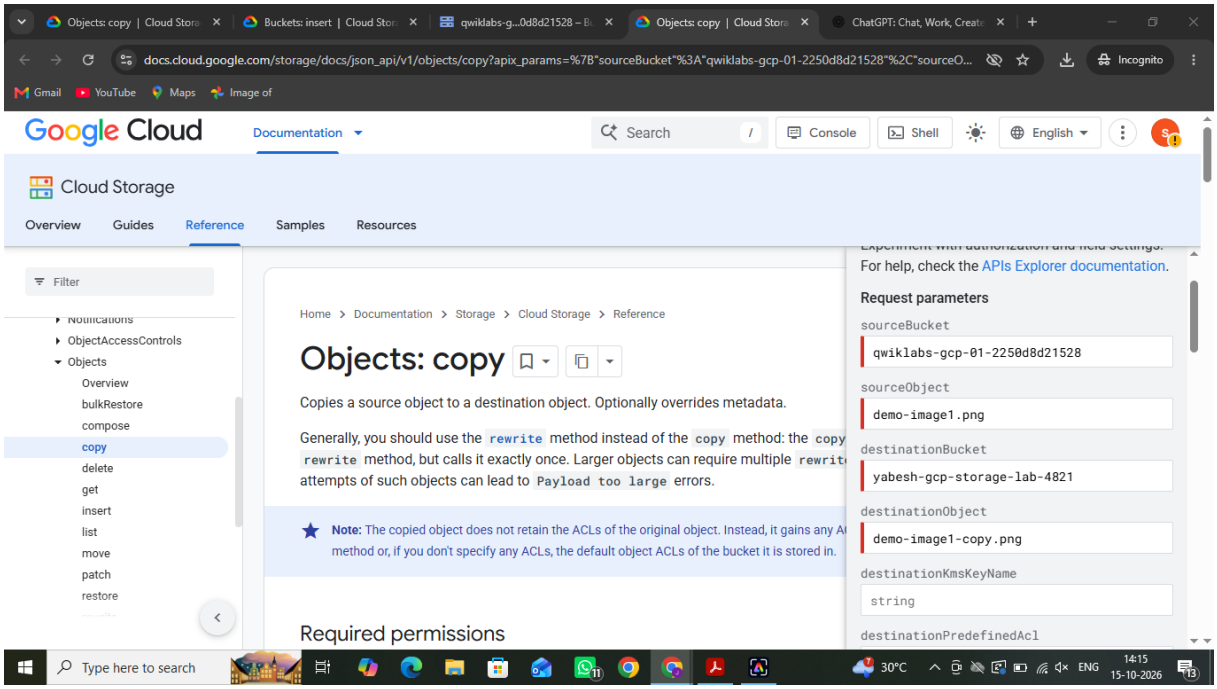


Figure 6: Objects: copy – source and destination bucket and object names.

The API returned **200** with a *storage#object* resource named demo-image1-copy.png in the destination bucket, content type image/png, size 401,951 bytes.

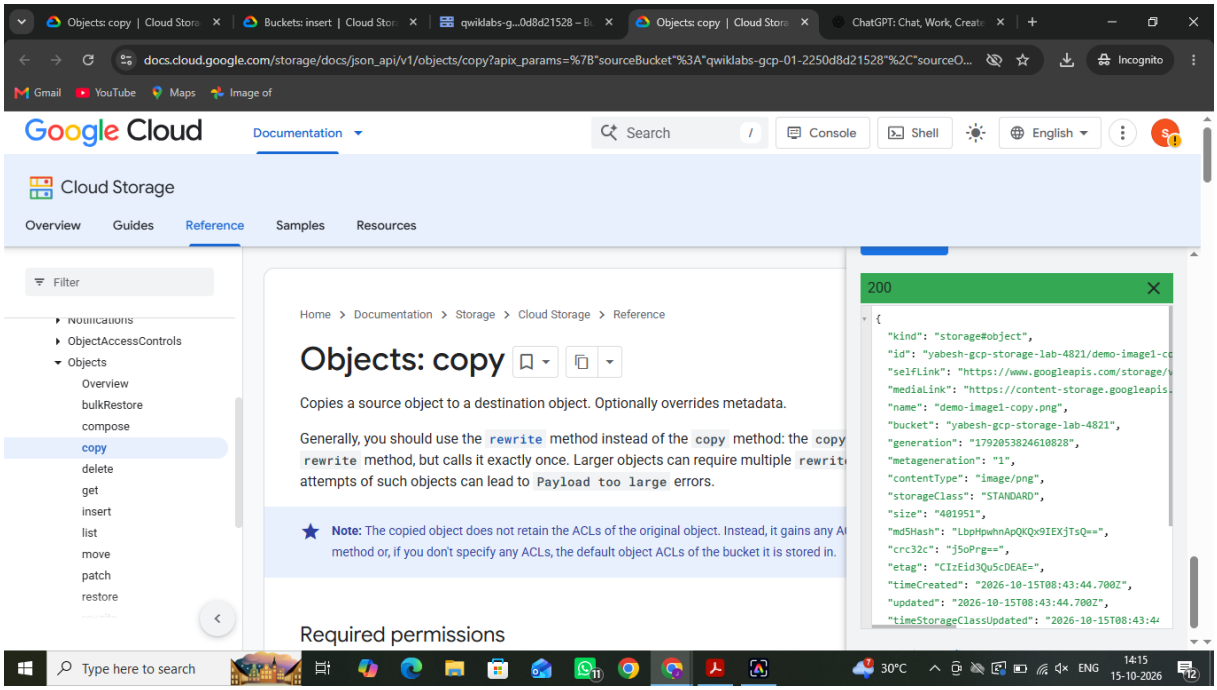


Figure 7: 200 response from Objects: copy.

The console confirms that the second bucket now holds the copy.

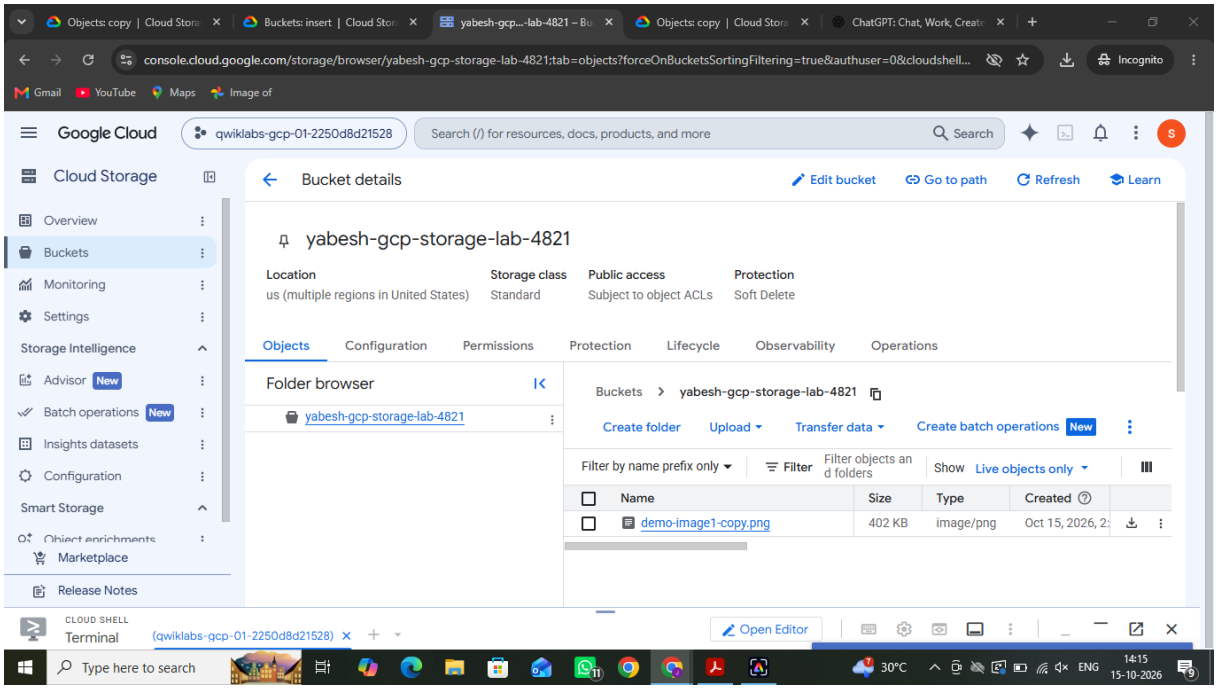


Figure 8: Second bucket (yabesh-gcp-storage-lab-4821) showing demo-image1-copy.png (402 KB, image/png).

Task 5 – Delete files

The **Objects: delete** method takes a **bucket** and an **object**. I ran it for demo-image1.png and then demo-image2.png in the first bucket. A successful delete returns **204 No Content**, and the first bucket was then empty.

Task 6 – Delete a bucket

With **Buckets: delete** and the first bucket's name in the **bucket** field, the empty bucket was removed (204). A bucket must be empty before it can be deleted through this method, which is why the objects were removed first.

5. Lab Completion

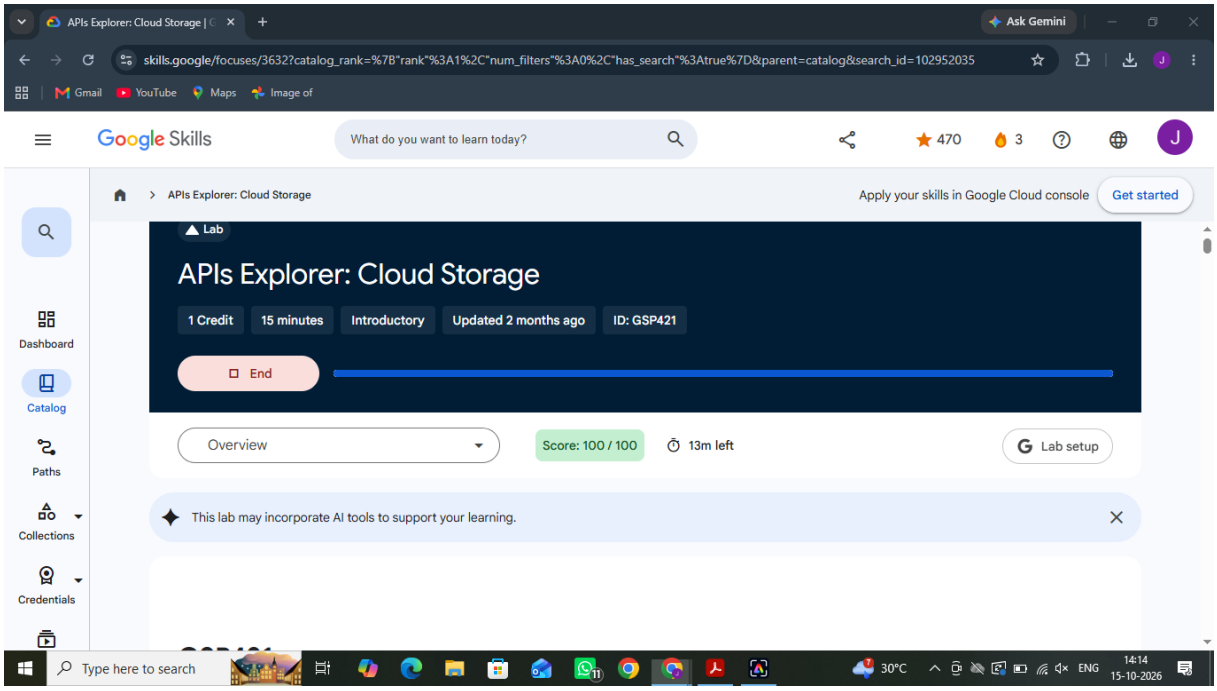


Figure 9: Lab completed with a score of 100/100.

Knowledge-check answers

- **Each bucket has a default storage class, which you can specify when you create the bucket:** True.
- **Every bucket must have a unique name across the entire Cloud Storage namespace:** True.

6. Key Takeaways

- The APIs Explorer runs real, authenticated API calls from the browser, which is a quick way to learn what a method needs and returns.
- **Buckets: insert** needs the project ID and a globally unique bucket name; the optional settings (location, storage class) default to US multi-region and Standard.
- **Objects: copy** uses the source bucket and object plus the destination bucket and object, so the copy can be renamed.
- A **200** response returns the created or copied resource. A **204** response means a delete succeeded with no body.
- A bucket has to be empty before **Buckets: delete** will remove it.
- Everything done in the console can also be done through the REST API, which is the basis for scripts, SDKs and tools like gcloud.

7. Conclusion

The lab was completed with a score of 100/100. I enabled the Cloud Storage JSON API, created two buckets, uploaded and copied objects, and used the API methods for deletion, working with Cloud Storage programmatically through the APIs Explorer.